MIL-D-14172B (Ord)
14 December 1961
SUPERSEDING
MIL-D-14172A (Ord)
1 March 1960

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

DETONATOR, ELECTRIC, M51
LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the loading, assembling and packing for one type of electric detonator designated as Detonator, Electric, M51.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment.
MIL-B-117 - Bags, Interior Packing.
MIL-A-148 - Aluminium Foil.
MIL-A-2550 - Ammunition and Special Weapons; General Specification for.
MIL-P-14077 - Polytetrafluoroethylene (Teflon), Molding and Extruding Materials or Extruded Parts, Sheets, Rods and Tubing.
MIL-I-45208 - Inspection Requirements, General Specification for.
MIL-I-45607 - Inspection Equipment, Supply and Maintenance of.

FSC: 1336

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STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-109 - Inspection Terms and Definitions.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWINGS

ORDNANCE CORPS

8796020 - Detonator, Electric, M51, Assembly.

PUBLICATIONS

ORDNANCE CORPS

ORD-M608-11 - Procedures and Tables for Continuous Sampling by Attributes.
IEL-8780867 - Index of Inspection Equipment Lists.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.-Materials shall be in accordance with applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Detonator.-The detonator shall comply with all requirements specified on Drawing (dwg.) 8796020 and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Moisture content of lead azide.-The moisture content of the lead azide at the loading station at the time of loading, shall not exceed 0.50 percent when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

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3.4 Moisture content of PETN.-The moisture content of the PETN at the loading plant at the time of loading the detonator shall not exceed 0.50 percent when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.5 Waterproofness.-The detonator shall be waterproof as evidenced by normal functioning after immersion in water for not less than 48 hours at a depth of 2 to 3 inches at a temperature of 20 degrees Centigrade (C.) plus or minus 1 degree C.

3.6 Functioning at 70 degrees Fahrenheit (F.) plus or minus 10 degrees F.

3.6.1 Time.-The detonators shall fire on the first attempt within 10 microseconds when tested as specified in 4.3.5.

3.6.2 Output.-The detonators shall fire on the first attempt and shall cause perforation of the lead disc to not less than 3/16 inch diameter minimum (min.) when tested as specified in 4.3.6.

3.6.3 Duds.-The detonators shall fire on the first attempt when tested as specified in 4.3.7.

3.7 Workmanship.-All parts and assemblies shall be fabricated and finished in a thorough, workmanlike manner. They shall be neat, clean and free from burrs, sharp edges, excessive flash, distortion, unblended radii, surface defects, chips, dirt, grease, flux, weld splatter, rust, corrosion productions (as applicable) and other foreign matter. The cleaning method shall not be injurious to any part nor shall the parts be contaminated by the cleaning agent. All required marking shall be neat and sharply defined.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 General quality assurance provisions.-The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The

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Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Reference shall be made to Standard MIL-STD-109 in order to define terms used herein. The provisions of Specification MIL-A-2550 shall apply.

4.1.1 Contractor quality assurance system.-The contractor shall provide and maintain an effective quality assurance system in compliance with the requirements of Specification MIL-I-45208.

4.1.2 Submission of product.-At the time the completed lot of product is submitted to the Government for acceptance the contractor shall supply the following information accompanied by a certificate which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted:

a. A statement that the lot complies with all quality assurance provisions of the approved current written description of the system.

b. Number of units of product inspected.

c. Results obtained for all inspection performed.

d. Drawing, specification number and date, together with an identification and date of changes.

e. Certificates of analysis on all material procured directly by the contractor when such material is controlled by Government specifications referenced in any of the contractual documents.

f. Number of items in the lot.

g. Date submitted.

The certificate shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certificate submitted shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principal. Substantiation of the agent's authority will not be required with subsequent certificates unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

4.1.3 Government verification.-Using the contractor's written quality assurance procedure, this detail specification, the applicable drawings and other contractual documents as a guide, the Government inspector shall verify at unscheduled intervals all

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quality assurance operations performed by the contractor. Verification will be in accordance with Specification MIL-I-45208 and will be performed to the extent necessary to assure compliance with the contractual requirements. Severity of Government inspection of individual characteristics will be directly related to the seriousness of the classification assigned. In no instance will a characteristic classified "critical" be accepted solely on the basis of the contractor's records.

4.2 Inspection provisions.

4.2.1 Lot formation.-A lot shall consist of electric detonators produced by one manufacturer in one unchanged process, in accordance with the same drawing, same drawing revision, same specification, and same specification revision. Drawing, specification, and process changes not affecting safety, performance or fit, as determined by the Government shall not necessitate changing the lot number. Each lot shall contain:

a. parts bearing the same interfix lot number from one manufacturer.

b. lead azide from one lot from one manufacturer.

c. PETN from one lot from one manufactuer.

4.2.2 Examination.-Sampling plans and procedures for the following classifications of defects shall be in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-105 except that inspection for critical defects, when listed, shall be 100 percent. Continuous sampling plans in accordance with Handbook ORD-M608-11 may be used if approved by the procuring activity. Also, at the option of the procuring activity, AQL's and sampling plans may be applied to the individual characteristics listed using an AQL of 0.25 percent for each major defect and an AQL of 0.40 percent for each minor defect. Equipment necessary for the performance of the inspections listed shall be in accordance with 4.2.4.

4.2.2.1 Bridge and plug assembly, prior to applying spot charge (see dwg. 8796136 covering a detail of dwg. 8796020).

Categories	Defects	Method of inspection
Critical: None defined		
Major:	AQL 0.25 percent	
101.	Bridge wire missing or not covering end of leads	Visual
102.	Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.7)....	Visual

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Minor: None defined

4.2.2.2 Bridge and plug assembly (see dwg. 8796136 covering a detail of dwg. 8796020).

Categories	Defects	Method of inspection
Critical: None defined		
Major:	AQL 0.25 percent	
101.	Spot charge exhibiting voids, cracks or separations	Visual
102.	Spot charge missing	Visual
Minor: None defined		

4.2.2.3 Assembly, prior to loading priming charge (see dwg. 8796020).

Categories	Defects	Method of inspection
Major:	AQL 0.25 percent	
101.	Height of base charge	Gage
Minor: None defined		

4.2.2.4 Assembly (see dwg. 8796020).

Categories	Defects	Method of inspection
Critical:		
1.	Insulation not removed from lead wire	Visual
2.	Lead wire not adequately twisted	Visual
3.	Lead wire broken	Visual
4.	Cup split or cracked	Visual
Major:	AQL 0.65 percent	
101.	Resistance of lead circuit	Test (see 4.3.3)
102.	Resistance between shorted lead wires and cup	Test (see 4.3.4)
103.	Outside diameter, maximum (max.)	Gage

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104.	Total length of body, max.	Gage
105.	Moisture proof varnish missing or not applied 360 degrees	Visual
106.	Crimp not full 360 degrees	Visual
107.	Plug broken or cracked	Visual

Minor: AQL 1.00 percent

201.	Marking misleading or unidentifiable ...	Visual
202.	Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.7).....	Visual

4.2.2.5 Bundle or pocket assemblies prior to securing (see 5.1.1.1 and 5.1.1.2).

Categories	Defects	Method of inspection

Critical: None defined

Major: AQL 0.40 percent

101.	Incorrect number of detonators	Visual
102.	Lead wire not around bundle	Visual
103.	Detonator inverted (when applicable)...	Visual
104.	Aluminum foil damaged	Visual

Minor: None defined

4.2.2.6 Bundle or pocket assemblies (see 5.1.1.1 and 5.1.1.2).

Categories	Defects	Method of inspection

Critical: None defined

Major: AQL 0.25 percent

101.	Adhesive seal inadequate (when applicable).....	Visual
102.	Contents exposed (when applicable)	Visual

Minor: AQL 0.40 percent

201.	Tip not folded (when applicable)..	Visual

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4.2.2.7 Carton, prior to inserting into waterproof bag (see 5.1.1.1 and 5.1.1.2).

Categories	Defects	Method of inspection
Critical:	None defined	
Major:	AQL 0.40 percent	
	101. Carton damaged	Visual
	102. Incorrect number of bundles (when applicable)	Visual
	103. Incorrect number of pocket assemblies (when applicable)	Visual
Minor:	AQL 1.40 percent	
	201. Label missing (applicable to method 1A)	Visual
	202. Marking data misleading or unidentifiable	Visual
	203. Patent marking missing	Visual

4.2.2.8 Water vapor-proof bag (see 5.1.1.1 and 5.1.1.2).

Categories	Defects	Method of inspection
Critical:	None defined	
Major:	AQL 0.25 percent	
	101. Box damaged	Visual
Minor:	AQL 1.00 percent	
	201. Seal missing or improperly located	Visual
	202. Marking missing or unidentifiable	Visual

4.2.3 Testing.

4.2.3.1 Moisture content of lead azide (see 3.3) - Major defect.-The moisture content of the lead azide shall be determined for each lot at the time of loading. A sample of 2 grams shall be selected and tested as specified in 4.3.1. If the moisture content is in excess of the percentage specified and loading has not begun, the lot of lead azide shall be rejected until proper corrective action has been accomplished as verified by repeating the moisture content test specified in 4.3.1. If loading has begun, action on the unloaded lead azide shall be as specified above and all detonators loaded with the questionable lead azide shall be rejected.

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4.2.3.2 Moisture content of PETN (see 3.4) - Major defect.- The moisture content of the PETN shall be determined for each lot at the time of loading. A sample of 5 grams shall be selected and tested as specified in 4.3.2. If the moisture content is in excess of the percentage specified and loading has not begun, the lot of PETN shall be rejected until proper corrective action has been accomplished as verified by repeating the moisture content test specified in 4.3.2. If loading has begun, action on the unloaded PETN shall be as specified above and all detonators loaded with the questionable PETN shall be rejected.

4.2.3.3 Functioning and waterproofness.-A sample of 185 complete detonators shall be selected from each lot and the sample reapportioned as specified for testing in the sequence that follows at a temperature of 70 degrees F. plus or minus 10 degrees F.

4.2.3.3.1 Functioning time and duds (see 3.6.1 and 3.6.3) - Major defect.-A portion of 35 detonators shall be subjected to the functioning time test specified in 4.3.5 using test equipment as specified in 4.2.4. The lot shall be rejected if the mean functioning time, plus the product of 2.27 and the standard deviation of the sample exceeds 10 microseconds. Detonators that fail to fire shall not be considered in the required calculation, but will be replaced with detonators from the remaining portion of the original sample. If three duds are encountered while performing this test the lot shall be rejected and testing for acceptance by the Government shall be stopped. Subsequent testing for waterproofness, duds and output shall not be conducted. The standard deviation shall be calculated using the formula in 6.4 or equivalent.

4.2.3.3.2 Waterproofness, output and duds (see 3.5, 3.6.2 and 3.6.3) - Major defect.-If the lot has not been rejected in 4.2.3.3.1, a portion of 50 detonators shall be tested as specified in 4.3.6 using test equipment as specified in 4.2.4. The lot shall be rejected if two or more detonators fail to produce a perforation in the disc of the required size. Detonators that fail to fire shall be replaced with detonators from the remaining portion of the original sample. If a total of three duds has been encountered during the time and output tests combined, the lot shall be rejected and further testing for acceptance by the Government shall be stopped. If a total of three duds has not been

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encountered but one detonator fails to produce a perforation in the disc of the required size, the balance of the original samples shall be tested as specified in 4.3.6. The lot shall be rejected and testing for Government acceptance shall be stopped if and when one more detonator fails to produce a perforation in the disc of the required size, or when a total of three duds are encountered in all of the combined testing.

4.2.3.3.3 Duds (see 3.6.3) - Major defect.-If all of the first 50 detonators tested in 4.2.3.3.2 function satisfactorily in the output phase, and the lot has not been rejected for duds, the remaining portion of the original sample shall be subjected to the test for duds specified in 4.3.7, using test equipment as specified in 4.2.4. The lot shall be rejected when and if a total of three duds is encountered in all of the combined testing and testing for Government acceptance shall be stopped. If two duds are encountered, a second sample of 370 detonators shall be selected from the lot and subjected to the test specified in 4.3.7. Testing shall be stopped for Government acceptance and the lot shall be rejected if and when the total number of duds in all combined testing reaches three.

4.2.4 Inspection equipment.-For the performance of the inspections listed herein, the contractor shall have available and utilize correctly all necessary gages, measuring and testing equipment identified by Index of Inspection Equipment Lists No. 8780867, or approved equivalents thereto. Designs of equipment developed by the contractor for use in lieu of that specified in the Index of Inspection Equipment Lists shall be documented and submitted to the Government for approval as equivalent (see 6.2). Approval shall be obtained prior to initiation of production. Supply and maintenance of inspection equipment shall be in accordance with Specification MIL-I-45607.

4.3 Test methods and procedures.

4.3.1 Determination of moisture content of lead azide.-A tared dried aluminum dish 2 inches in diameter shall be covered with a sheet of teflon conforming to Specification MIL-P-14077, 2 1/2 inches square and sufficiently flat to form a tight cover.

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An accurately weighed sample of approximately 2 grams shall be transferred to the moisture dish while both the cover and dish are on the balance pan. The dish and contents shall be transferred to an oven and dried at 95 degrees Centigrade (C.) plus or minus 2 degrees C. for 2 hours. The cover shall be placed in the sulfuric acid desiccator during the drying period. After drying, the dish shall be quickly transferred to the desiccator and allowed to cool to room temperature. The teflon cover shall be placed on the dish and the assembly weighed. The loss in weight shall be calculated to percentage of moisture in the lead azide as follows:

$$\text{percentage of moisture} = \frac{(A-B) \times 100}{A}$$

where:

A = weight of the sample before drying.
B = weight of the sample after drying.

4.3.2 Determination of moisture content of PETN.-Approximately 5 grams of PETN shall be placed in a tared glass weighing dish. The dish and its contents shall be weighed, dried at 100 degrees C. plus or minus 2 degrees C. for 1 hour, cooled in a desiccator and weighed. The loss in weight shall be calculated to the percentage of moisture in the PETN.

4.3.3 Resistance of lead circuit.-Before shorting the lead wires, the resistance of the detonator shall be measured with an electrical ohmmeter, using not more than 20 microampere of current. Test equipment shall be as specified in 4.2.4. Any detonator which fails to comply with the specified requirement shall be classed defective.

4.3.4 Resistance between shorted lead wires and cup.-The detonator shall be connected to the applicable test fixture specified in 4.2.4. An electrical potential of 500 volts 60 cycles (r.m.s.) shall be applied for 2 seconds, maximum, between the shorted lead wires and the cup. Any detonator which fails to comply with the specified requirement shall be classed defective.

4.3.5 Functioning time.-The detonator shall be assembled to the specified test fixture and connected electrically to the test circuit specified. The energy from a 0.0022 microfarad

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capacitor charged to 300 volts, maximum shall be discharged to fire the detonator. The functioning time shall be measured as the time from when the energy is released until functioning of the detonator causes the electronic counter to stop. The time shall be recorded and the appropriate action taken with respect to duds.

4.3.6 Waterproofness and output.-The detonator shall be submerged in water for the time specified and at the depth and temperature specified. The detonator shall be removed from the water and within 15 minutes fired by releasing the energy from a 0.0022 microfarad capacitor charged to 300 volts maximum. Observation shall be made for dimension of the perforation in the lead disc and for duds.

4.3.7 Duds.-The detonator shall be connected electrically to the test circuit specified and the energy from a 0.0022 microfarad capacitor charged to 300 volts maximum shall be discharged to fire the detonator. Observation shall be made for duds.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level B (see 6.5).

5.1.1.1 Rosette wrap.-A bundle of 25 detonators shall be made, lead wires out straight, using the lead wires from one detonator to secure the bundle. Each bundle of detonators shall be wrapped in a sheet of approximately 8 x 8 x .0015 inch thick aluminum foil complying with Specification MIL-A-148, so that all detonators and lead wires in a bundle are completely encased by the foil. Five bundles of detonators, totaling 125 detonators, shall be packed in a folding carton, set-up box, or comparable container made of material with a minimum board thickness of .03 inch. Each carton, after blunting corners, shall be placed in a water vapor-proof bag manufactured of barrier material in accordance with Type I, Class e, MIL-B-117. The bag shall be closed. All excess air shall be exhausted within the bag and sealed in accordance with manufacturer's instructions with seal located at edge of bag to provide for minimum of 2 subsequent seals if required. The seals shall comply with Specification MIL-B-117.

Alternately: Method 1A2 in accordance with Specification MIL-P-116 may be used with package overwrapped with 30 lb. commercial Kraft paper.

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5.1.1.2 Pocket assembly, alternate pack.-The detonators shall be packed in pocket assemblies manufactured in accordance with figure 1 (as applicable) made of .0015 inch aluminum foil complying with Specification MIL-A-148. An adhesive seal shall be used to bond the faces of the aluminum foil together to form five pockets. The adhesive used for the sealing of the two faces of the aluminum foil shall be suitable for the application. The strength of the seal shall be sufficient to allow the insertion of the dowel (see figure 1) without separation of the seal. The two faces of any seal shall not be misaligned by more than 1/16 inch when the pouch is formed. Each pocket shall be opened to form a cylinder using a smooth dowel with rounded end similar to that shown on figure 1 (as applicable). Each pocket may, however, be opened by other suitable methods which will result in providing a satisfactory pocket for insertion of the detonator without injury to the material. One electric detonator shall be inserted, detonator end down, in each pocket. The lip of the pocket assembly shall be folded over to form a closed pouch. Twenty-five pocket assemblies, or a total of 125 detonators shall be packed in a folding carton, set-up box, or comparable container made of material with a minimum board thickness of .03 inch. Each carton, after blunting corners, shall be placed in a water vapor-proof bag manufactured of barrier material in accordance with Type I, Class e, MIL-B-117. The bag shall be closed. All excess air shall be exhausted within the bag and sealed in accordance with manufacturer's instructions with seal located at edge of bag to provide for a minimum of 2 subsequent seals if required. The seals shall comply with Specification MIL-B-117.

Alternatively: Method 1A2 in accordance with Specification MIL-P-116 may be used with package overwrapped with 30 lb. commercial Kraft paper.

5.1.2 Level C.-Unless otherwise specified, the detonators shall be preserved and packaged as specified in 5.1.1, except that no water vapor-proof protection is required.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level B (see 6.5).-A suitable number of containers, each containing 125 detonator assemblies, shall be packed in an outer case in accordance with Tariff #10, Interstate Commerce Commission Regulations for Transportation of Explosives and Other Dangerous Articles, Paragraph 73.66 (see Code of Federal Regulations 49 CFR 71-90).

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5.2.2 Level C.-Unless otherwise specified, the detonators shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1.

5.3 Marking.-Interior packages and exterior containers shall be marked in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-129. When the barrier bag is used, the marking shall be applied directly to the bag. Cartons may be marked with labels or printed directly on the carton. When alternative method of water vapor protection is used, 3 labels shall be required; one applied to the carton, and one each applied to inner and outer wrapper. The ICC designation shall be: Electric Blasting Caps-Handle Carefully. The number of caps packed in one outer pack shall be shown in the marking. Interior packages shall be clearly marked in approximately 1/8 inch letters "Patented - U.S. Patent 2,389,086" (see 6.6).

5.4 Data cards.-Data card information shall be as specified in Specification MIL-A-2550.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.-Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Applicable level of packaging and packing (see 6.5).

6.2 Submission of contractor equipment desings.-Documentation of contractor developed equipment designs shall be submitted in duplicate to Picatinny Arsenal, Dover, New Jersey, ATTN: ORDBB-ND, for approval. This documentation shall identify all standard devices and set-ups etc., as well as special equipment designs.

6.3 Check test for possible deterioration.-The following test is designed to prevent the loading of detonators which have deteriorated into a major ammunition item. The test should be performed on detonators which have been stored under normal conditions for more than two years or under adverse conditions for any period of time. If the specification for the ammunition item into which the detonators are loaded does not require that the check test be performed, the contracting officer should insert a provision for the performance of the check test in the contract. Two hundred (200) detonators shall be selected from each lot for this test.

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6.3.1 Functioning time and duds.-Forty (40) detonators shall be subjected to the test specified in 4.3.5. Observation shall be made for the functioning time and all duds that may occur shall be recorded. Duds will be replaced by detonators from the 200 selected. If the mean time (X) plus 2.03 times the standard deviation (s) exceeds 10 microseconds, the lot shall be rejected. The standard deviation shall be computed from the formula in 6.4, or equivalent. Duds shall not enter into the calculation for standard deviation.

6.3.2 Waterproofness output and duds.-Fifty (50) detonators shall be subjected to the test specified in 4.3.6. Observation shall be made of the perforation in the disc, and the number of duds that may occur shall be recorded. Duds shall be replaced from the 200 selected. If two detonators fail to adequately perforate the lead disc, a retest shall be permitted using the balance of the detonators selected in 6.3. If during the retest, one more detonator fails to adequately perforate the lead disc, the retest shall be stopped and the lot rejected. During the retest the number of duds that may occur shall be recorded. If three or more detonators fail to adequately perforate the lead disc during the original test the lot shall be rejected without retest.

6.3.3 Duds.-If no retest is required in the output phase, the balance of the detonators selected in 6.3 shall be subjected to the test for duds as specified in 4.3.7. The number of duds that may occur will be recorded. If more than two but not more than six duds are found a retest shall be permitted using double the number of detonators selected in 6.3. The lot shall be rejected during retest as soon as the total number of duds observed in 6.3.1, 6.3.2 and 6.3.3 is equal to seven. If in the original sample of 200, seven or more duds are observed the lot shall be rejected without retest.

6.4 Formula for computing standard deviation.-The standard deviation shall be computed as specified in Handbook ORD-M608-10 or equivalent.

6.5 Level B packaging and packing.-In the event the expected storage time is in excess of 180 days the waterproof bag shall be used as specified in 5.1.1.1. The expected storage time shall be determined by the procuring activity.

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6.6 The United States Government has negotiated a license agreement covering manufacture of items within the scope of this patent with Hercules Powder Company.

Notice.-When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any right or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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